One Day Top

Written walkthrough for sizes S and M · pattern by Svetlana Volkova (Tweedysheep)

A boat-neck top worked from the top down in stockinette. It is knit in three stages: in the round for the shoulders, flat for the back and front above the underarm, then in the round again for the body. Numbers are given as **S / M**.

The shape in one breath. You cast on the neckline and grow outward to the shoulders (in the round). At the underarm you split into back and front and work each one flat, widening both edges. Then you join them and knit the body down in the round.

At a glance

	S	M
Finished chest	36.1 in / 92 cm	39.4 in / 100 cm
Neck circumference	19.0 in	19.7 in
Armhole depth	7.9 in	8.3 in
Body length after join	7 in / 18 cm	7 in / 18 cm
Yarn (bulky/worsted)	425 yds	485 yds
Cast on	50 sts	52 sts
Each big section in the set-up round	24 sts	25 sts
Round 1 worked	7 times	8 times
Stitches after the yoke	78	84
Back / front after the divide	38 / 40	41 / 43
Rows 3-4 worked	8 times	9 times
Back / front after shaping	54 / 56	59 / 61
Stitches after the join	110	120

Materials

- US 11 (8 mm) circular needles, long enough for magic loop
- Bulky/worsted weight yarn, about 425 / 485 yds, to match gauge
- Scrap yarn, markers, tapestry needle

Gauge: 12 sts and 20 rows = 10 cm / 4 in in stockinette after blocking.

Abbreviations

- **BOR** beginning of round · **CO** cast on · **BO** bind off · **RS / WS** right / wrong side · **k** knit · **p** purl · **m** marker · **pm / sm** place / slip marker
- **s2b** slip 2 sts from left to right needle with yarn at the back
- **s2f** slip 2 sts from left to right needle with yarn in front
- **m1l** make one left: with the left needle, pick up the bar between stitches from front to back and knit through the back loop
- **m1r** make one right: with the left needle, pick up the bar between stitches from back to front and knit through the front loop

Work m1l and m1r loosely. The increase stitches are underlined in orange wherever they appear below.

1. Cast on and set up

> `CO 50 / 52 sts rather loosely. Join to work in the round and pm for BOR.`
>
> `You may hold two needles together for a long-tail cast on. A loose edge matters because this is the neckline.`

> `Set-up round: k1, pm, k24 / 25, pm, k1, pm, k24 / 25.`
>
> `Count: 50 / 52 sts.`

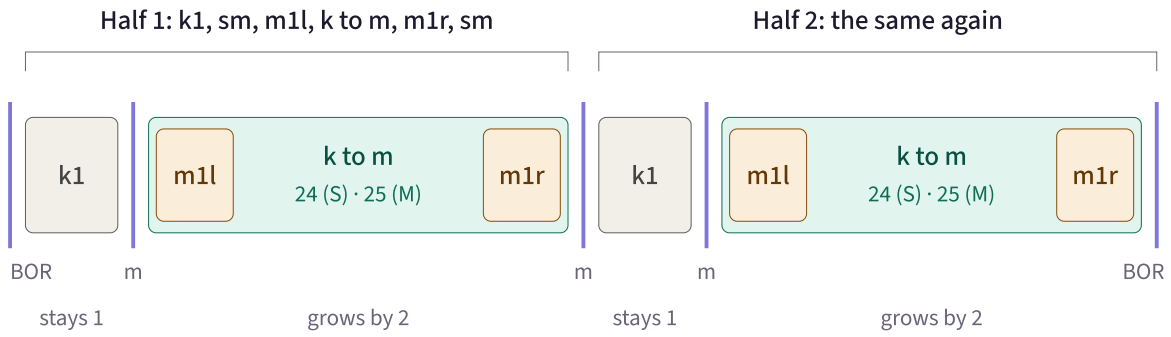
What the set-up round builds. You now have four parts: `k1` | big section | `k1` | big section. The two single stitches never grow. They are the shoulder lines. All the growth happens in the two big sections, at their ends, next to those markers.

2. Yoke: Round 1

> `Round 1: k1, sm, m1l, k to m, m1r, sm, repeat from the beginning once.`
> `+4 sts.`

"Repeat from the beginning once" means you do the sequence **twice in total**, once for each big section. Written out in full, the round is:

> `k1, sm, m1l, k to m, m1r, sm, k1, sm, m1l, k to m, m1r, sm`



Size S: 1 + 24 + 1 + 24 = 50 sts → 1 + 26 + 1 + 26 = 54 sts
Size M: 1 + 25 + 1 + 25 = 52 sts → 1 + 27 + 1 + 27 = 56 sts

Round 1 laid out flat, BOR at the left to BOR at the right. Gray = single stitches, teal = big sections, orange = new stitches.

Repeat Round 1 **7 / 8 times in total** (the first pass counts). Each pass adds 4 stitches:

AFTER ROUND	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Size S (start 50)	54	58	62	66	70	74	78	–
Size M (start 52)	56	60	64	68	72	76	80	84

You end with **78 / 84 sts**.

3. Divide front and back

Turn to the WS and purl to m. Place all remaining sts to BOR m onto scrap yarn and remove all markers.

You now have 38 / 41 back sts on the needles and 40 / 43 front sts on scrap yarn.

Why the front is 2 stitches wider. Purling back from the BOR marker takes you through only the *last* big section, and that section is the back. Everything else goes on the scrap yarn: the other big section *and both single stitches*. So the front is the back plus 2.

4. Back (worked flat)

ROWS 1 AND 2, REPEAT UNTIL 13 CM

Row 1 (RS): s2b, k to end.

Row 2 (WS): s2f, p to end.

Work these two rows until the piece measures 13 cm (5 in). At gauge that is about 26 rows, or 13 pairs. That row count is my own estimate from the gauge, not from the pattern, so go by the tape measure.

The slipped edge. The first two stitches of every row are slipped, not worked: yarn at the back on RS rows, in front on WS rows. They are never knit after the divide, so they stretch into a long rope-like edge. That edge is what you see around the armholes in the designer's photos. Keep the slip tension relaxed so the edge does not pucker.

ROWS 3 AND 4, WORK 8 / 9 TIMES

> Row 3 (RS): s2b, k1, m1l, k to 3 sts before end, m1r, k3.
>
> +2 sts.
>
> Row 4 (WS): s2f, p to end.

After each Row 3 and Row 4 pair the back has 2 more stitches:

BACK COUNT AFTER PAIR	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Size S (start 38)	40	42	44	46	48	50	52	54	–
Size M (start 41)	43	45	47	49	51	53	55	57	59

What these rows do. The increases are at the two side edges, so the back gets wider as it goes down. This is the shaping that turns the shoulder strap into the underarm. It is not neck shaping: the neckline is the cast-on edge at the top.

> Cut yarn and place all back sts onto scrap yarn.
>
> = 54 / 59 sts.

5. Front (worked flat)

Pick up the front stitches from the scrap yarn and work exactly as the back: Rows 1-2 until 13 cm, then Rows 3-4 **8 / 9 times**.

FRONT COUNT AFTER PAIR	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Size S (start 40)	42	44	46	48	50	52	54	56	–
Size M (start 43)	45	47	49	51	53	55	57	59	61

Rejoining yarn. The pattern does not say how to restart the front. Since the yarn was cut after the back, join a new strand at the start of a RS row. This is my note, not the designer's.

6. Join and body

> With RS facing, join front and back.
>
> = 110 / 120 sts (54 + 56 for S, 59 + 61 for M).

> Work in the round in stockinette (knit every round) for 18 cm (7 in) or until the desired length.

> BO all sts knitwise.

Finishing

- Weave in all ends.
- Wet block. When the top is almost dry, put it on a hanger. The designer says this shapes the neckline the right way.

Fit notes

- **Front and back are the same length.** They are worked with identical rows, so there is no bust shaping, no extra front length and no short rows. The front is only 2 stitches (about 1.7 cm) wider.
- **Choosing a size:** the pattern sizes by finished chest (36.1 in S, 39.4 in M). It is a boxy, cropped top in an open stitch, so the fit relies on ease and stretch.
- **If you want more room at the bust** (my ideas, not the pattern's, and untested): size up by your full bust, or add a few short rows across the front after the join. Do not make the front panel taller than the back, because the side edges are joined and would stop matching.

Pattern and design © 2024 Svetlana Volkova / Tweedysheep. This is a personal-use written walkthrough for sizes S and M, with notes added for clarity. The original states that it may not be reproduced, sold or re-knit for profit, so please do not redistribute it. The stitch counts were checked against the original size tables.